2

TRACK A · AI FOUNDATIONS · KIT 2 OF 20

Prompting Basics: Getting Useful Results Every Time

Word-for-Word Facilitator Script: read it aloud exactly as written, or make it your own. Keyed to all 30 slides, with stage directions, a running clock, and answers to the questions staff actually ask.

Facilitator Script · 45–60 minutes

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi

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How to use this script

Everything in plain type is meant to be spoken aloud. Read it verbatim (it's written for the ear) or glance and paraphrase once you're comfortable. Either way delivers a complete session. Slide cues, stage directions, and question boxes work exactly as they did in Kit 1. If your school hasn't run Kit 1 yet, run it first; this session builds on its two rules (no student PII in public tools; a human reviews everything).

Timing checkpoints

Clock	You should be...	If behind...
0:12	Starting the four-part formula (slide 9)	Trim discussion on slides 5–6
0:24	Starting iteration (slide 17)	Do two makeovers instead of three
0:30	Starting the lab (slide 20)	Start it anyway; the lab is the session
0:52	On First 48 Hours (slide 28)	Hold the closing lines; hand out sheets at the door

45-minute version: run one iteration round in the lab instead of two, take two share-out voices instead of four, and read the "45-min cut" stage notes where they appear.

Segment 1 · Welcome & the gap (slides 1–4)

SLIDE 1 Title 0:00

⟶ *Slide 1 up as people arrive. Start on time.*

Welcome back. Last session we agreed on the rules of the road: no student information in public AI tools, and a human reviews everything before it reaches a student or a family. Today is about the skill that turns AI from a curiosity into a colleague: writing prompts that get useful results every time, not just sometimes.

SLIDE 2 The gap 0:01

Here's the number that explains why this hour exists. In the big 2025 Gallup survey of teachers, about three in ten used AI weekly, and those weekly users saved nearly six hours a week. Meanwhile four in ten teachers didn't use AI at all. Same tools, same access. The difference between those two groups isn't the technology; it's a skill. And the skill is mostly one thing: knowing how to ask.

SLIDE 3 Why "just ask" fails — 0:03

Remember what these tools actually are, from Kit 1: prediction machines. They continue patterns. When you give a vague prompt, the model predicts the most likely, most average continuation. That's why vague prompts get generic answers: "Write a lesson on fractions" gets you the most average fractions lesson on the internet. Not wrong. Just beige. The fix isn't magic words. The fix is information: the model can only use what you give it.

> **If asked "is prompting just a fad until AI gets smarter?"** Fair question. Tools do keep getting better at guessing intent. But no tool can guess what only you know: your grade level, your students' needs, your constraints, your taste. Giving that context will matter in five years exactly as much as it matters today.

SLIDE 4 Agenda + one promise — 0:04

The hour: first, the anatomy of a prompt that works, four parts, no jargon. Then live makeovers: we take real, vague teacher prompts and fix them in front of you. Then the skill nobody talks about: iterating instead of settling. And then the heart of the session: you build one reusable prompt for a task you actually do every week, and leave with it saved. By the end of the year that one prompt may be worth hours. That's the promise: not theory, inventory.

Segment 2 · The anatomy of a good prompt (slides 5–8)

SLIDE 5 The colleague test — 0:05

One test predicts whether a prompt will work before you ever hit enter, and it comes from Anthropic's own documentation: show your prompt to a colleague with no context. If they'd be confused, the model will be too. That's the whole game. The model is like a brilliant new hire on their first day: enormously capable, knows nothing about your classroom, your school, or what you actually want. Write for that new hire.

SLIDE 6 Four parts, every time — 0:07

Across the official guides from OpenAI, Google, Anthropic, and the frameworks state education departments now teach, the advice converges on the same four parts. One: **Role.** Who should the AI be? "You are an experienced 4th grade teacher." Two: **Task.** What exactly do you want? One clear verb. Three: **Context.** What does it need to know? Grade level, prior knowledge, constraints, what you've already tried. Four: **Format.** What should the output look like? A table, a list of five, a one-page letter, a rubric with four levels.

Role, task, context, format. Say it once with me. That's the formula. Everything else today is practice.

> **If asked "do I need all four every time?"** No. For quick tasks, task plus format is often enough. But when output disappoints, the missing ingredient is almost always context. Add it before you give up.

SLIDE 7 Why it works 0:09

This isn't folklore. Researchers who tested structured, principled prompts against casual ones measured the difference: in one benchmark study, applying a set of clear prompt-design principles improved response quality by more than half on the strongest models. Specific in, specific out. The formula is just a reliable way to be specific.

SLIDE 8 The one thing prompts can't fix 0:10

Before the makeovers, one honest limit, because trust lives here. No prompt, no matter how good, turns off hallucination. A beautifully structured prompt can still produce an invented fact or a fake citation, delivered with total confidence. Prompting improves quality and fit. It does not replace verification. The Kit 1 rule rides along forever: anything factual gets checked before you rely on it.

> **[FOUNDER STORY · Katelyn or Adam]** One spoken story for this moment: a time one of you wrote a genuinely good prompt and the AI still got something confidently wrong, and you caught it on review. What was the task, what did it invent or botch, and how fast did you catch it? This story keeps the session honest right before we teach enthusiasm.

Segment 3 · Live makeovers (slides 9–16)

SLIDE 9 Makeover #1: the lesson plan 0:12

Let's fix real prompts. Round one, the classic. Before: "Write a lesson on fractions." You've seen what that gets. After: "You are an experienced 4th grade teacher. Draft a 45-minute introductory lesson on equivalent fractions for a class that has mastered basic fraction notation but confuses numerator and denominator when simplifying. Include a 5-minute warm-up, a hands-on activity using paper folding, and a 3-question exit check. Format as a table with timings."

Count the four parts with me: role, teacher. Task, draft a 45-minute intro lesson. Context, what they've mastered and where they're stuck. Format, table with timings, specific components. Same request. Completely different result.

SLIDE 10 Makeover #2: the parent message 0:15

Round two, communication, and notice the Kit 1 rule working alongside the formula. Before: "Write a note to parents about the field trip." After: "You are a warm, organized elementary teacher. Write a note to families about an upcoming museum field trip. Context: departure 8:30 a.m., return by 2 p.m., students need a bagged lunch and a signed permission slip by Friday. Reading level: accessible to busy families skimming on a phone. Format: under 150 words, with the three action items in a bulleted list." No student names anywhere, and none needed.

SLIDE 11 Makeover #3: differentiation 0:17

Round three, the one that saves the most time. Before: "Make this easier." After: "Rewrite this passage at a 3rd grade reading level. Keep every key idea and the section headings. Sentence length under 12 words where possible. Then add a 5-word vocabulary box with student-friendly definitions." Then you paste your passage. The difference between "easier" and a specification is the difference between hoping and knowing.

SLIDE 12 The spice rack 0:19

Four small ingredients that upgrade any prompt. **Constraints:** "under 150 words," "exactly five questions," "no worksheets that need a copier." **Audience:** "for students who have never seen this word," "for families skimming on a phone." **An example:** paste one question or one paragraph in the style you want and say "match this style." Nothing communicates taste like a sample. **Escape hatch:** tell it "ask me up to three clarifying questions before you start." That one line turns a guessing machine into an interviewer.

SLIDE 13 You try: diagnose the prompt 0:21

⟶ Read each prompt; the room calls out the missing part (role, task, context, or format). Brisk, 3 minutes. Answers: A missing context (what grade? what topic focus?). B missing format (what should "help" look like?). C missing task (no verb; it's a topic, not a request). D solid: all four present.

Four prompts on screen. For each one, call out what's missing: role, task, context, or format. A: "Write a quiz about the Revolution." B: "Help me with my struggling readers." C: "Photosynthesis." D: "You are a middle school science teacher. Create a 10-question review on photosynthesis for 7th graders who confuse it with respiration. Mix multiple choice and short answer. Include an answer key."

SLIDE 14 Templates beat memory 0:23

Nobody writes four-part prompts from scratch at 7 a.m. The professionals save templates: a prompt with blanks. "You are a [grade] teacher. Create a [number]-question review on [topic] for students who [what they struggle with]. Format: [format]. Include an answer key." Fill in four blanks, done in twenty seconds. Today's lab builds your first one, and our staff prompt doc is where they'll live so nobody solves the same problem twice.

Segment 4 · Iterate, don't settle (slides 15–19)

SLIDE 15 The first draft is a proposal 0:24

Here's the mindset shift that separates people who get real value from people who quit: the first response is not the answer. It's a proposal. In Kit 1 you practiced pushing back twice. Today we make it a system. Round one: fix the content. "Question 4 is too hard for the start of the unit." Round two: fix the voice. "This doesn't sound like me; warmer, fewer exclamation points." Round three: fix the details. "Shorten it by a third and make the directions a numbered list."

SLIDE 16 Iterate vs. start over 0:26

One judgment call: when the draft is eighty percent right, iterate. When it's fundamentally the wrong thing, don't argue with it for ten minutes; start a fresh prompt and put what you learned into the context. Knowing when to quit a thread is itself a skill, and it's one round, not five. Your time matters more than the tool's feelings. It doesn't have any.

SLIDE 17 Voice check 0:27

One more honest limit before the lab, and it's the one your students will someday need to hear too: AI output has a house style. Smooth, agreeable, a little beige. If everything you send home starts sounding like everything everyone else sends home, families notice. So the last iteration round is always the voice round: read it aloud, and if it doesn't sound like you, say so. "Blunter." "Warmer." "I'd never say 'furthermore.'" Your voice is a feature. Keep it.

> **[YOUR TAKE · Adam & Katelyn]** A plainly stated shared position for this moment: where is the line between letting AI polish your writing and losing your voice? What do you personally refuse to let AI write for you, and why? Staff trust the training more when its authors have a stated boundary of their own.

Segment 5 · The lab: build your reusable prompt (slides 18–23)

SLIDE 18 Lab setup 0:30

⟶ *Devices out, pairs formed inside two minutes. Announce the tool. Energy up; this is the session.*

Lab time, and today you're not making a throwaway. You're building a tool you'll use every week. Think of one task you do over and over: the Friday newsletter, the weekly quiz, leveling a reading, writing station directions. That's your target. Ground rules from Kit 1 apply: no student information, and nothing has to be perfect.

SLIDE 19 Lab step 1: draft with the formula 0:32

⟶ *6 minutes. Circulate. Weak prompts usually lack context; nudge with "what would a substitute need to know to do this right?"*

Step one: write your prompt with all four parts. Role. Task. Context, and be generous; what would a substitute need to know? Format, exactly what the output should look like. Then run it and read the draft like an editor, not a fan.

> **[LOCAL EXAMPLE · Adam or Katelyn]** Drop in one of your own real, current reusable prompts here, written exactly as you actually use it (Adam: something from the shop, e.g. your weekly toolbox-talk generator; Katelyn: something from early elementary, e.g. your center-directions rewriter). One real prompt from a real classroom tells the room this isn't theoretical.

SLIDE 20 Lab step 2: three rounds of iteration 0:38

⟶ *6 minutes. 45-min cut: one round instead of three, then straight to step 3.*

Step two: three rounds, in order. Content round: what's wrong or missing? Voice round: does it sound like you? Detail round: length, format, level. Push back like you would with a capable student teacher: specific, kind, and completely unafraid.

SLIDE 21 Lab step 3: template it and save it 0:44

Step three: turn what worked into a template. Replace the specifics with blanks: topic, grade, number of questions. Paste the final version into the staff prompt doc with your name and a one-line note about what it's for. Congratulations: you just wrote the first entry in your professional prompt library, and Kit 18 will grow it into a whole collection.

SLIDE 22 Share-out 0:46

⟶ 3–4 voices, one minute each. Ask one person to read their before AND after; the room hears the delta.

Let's hear a few. Read us your before and your after, and tell us the one change that made the biggest difference.

SLIDE 23 What you just built 0:49

Notice what happened in fifteen minutes. You went from asking the AI a question to owning a tool. That's the difference between the teachers saving six hours a week and everyone else. It was never about typing faster. It's a small library of prompts that fit your classroom, plus the reflex to push back until the output earns your name on it.

Segment 6 · Making it stick (slides 24–27)

SLIDE 24 The formula on one slide 0:50

The whole session on one slide. Role, task, context, format. The colleague test before you hit enter. Three rounds: content, voice, details. Template what works, save it, share it. And underneath it all, the permanent rules: no student information in, nothing unreviewed out.

SLIDE 25 Honest limits, again 0:51

What prompting cannot do, so nobody oversells it in the hallway: it can't make the model check facts, so you still verify. It can't know your students, so you still personalize. And it can't decide what's worth teaching, because that was never a formatting problem. Better prompts buy you time and quality. Judgment stays yours.

SLIDE 26 Our commitments, extended 0:52

Kit 1 gave us three commitments. Today adds a fourth, and it's the friendly one: when a prompt works, it goes in the staff doc. Nobody at this school solves the same problem twice. Can I get a nod on that?

SLIDE 27 What's next 0:53

Next in the series: Kit 3, AI for Planning and Differentiation, where this formula starts doing heavy lifting: leveled texts, scaffolds, and lesson materials for the range of learners actually in your room. Your reusable prompt from today comes with you.

Segment 7 · First 48 hours & close (slides 28–30)

SLIDE 28 Your first 48 hours — 0:54

Three small things within two days, each under fifteen minutes: use your new reusable prompt on the real task it was built for. Run the colleague test on one prompt before you send it. And post your template to the staff doc if you didn't finish in the lab. Tomorrow morning, coffee in hand, pick one.

SLIDE 29 Exit ticket — 0:55

⟶ *Distribute exit tickets; collect at the door. They're the school's PD documentation.*

Two minutes on the exit ticket: one technique you're taking, one prompt you still want help with, one thing you'll try. Your answers steer the follow-ups.

SLIDE 30 Close — 0:56

Last word. A good prompt is just clear thinking, written down. You already do the hard part every day: knowing your students, knowing your subject, knowing what good work looks like. Today you learned to hand that knowledge to a very fast intern in a way it can actually use. Keep the thinking. Delegate the typing. Thanks, everyone.

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